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ON FRIDAY, October 21, 1983, four days after Bud McFarlane took over his new post at the NSC, Nancy and I flew to Georgia for a golfing weekend at the Augusta National Golf Course with George Shultz, Don Regan, former U.S. Senator Nicholas Brady, and their wives. After the dispute over the NSC job, a series of frustrating meetings over Lebanon, and more battles with the Democrats over the budget, I was looking forward to a couple of days of relaxation, although I hadn't played golf in quite a while and didn't have high hopes for my performance on the links.

Shortly after four o'clock Saturday morning, Nancy and I were awakened by a telephone call from Bud, who was in Augusta as part of the traveling White House support team. He said it was urgent that I meet with him and George Shultz immediately in the living room of the Eisenhower Cottage, where we were staying. This was the cottage Ike always used whenever he was on a golfing vacation at Augusta. In robe and pajamas, I listened to them explain that the Organization of Eastern Caribbean States had asked us to intervene militarily on the island of Grenada, one of their neighbors in the Caribbean located ninety miles north of Venezuela. Via a secure telephone link with Washington, George Bush, serving in his role as head of the White House crisis management team, also participated in this middle-of-the-night conference.

We'd been watching events on Grenada very closely for several days. In a bloody coup the previous week, Grenada's prime minister, Maurice Bishop, a Marxist protégé of Fidel Castro who had invited Cuban workers to Grenada to build a suspiciously huge new airport on the island, had been